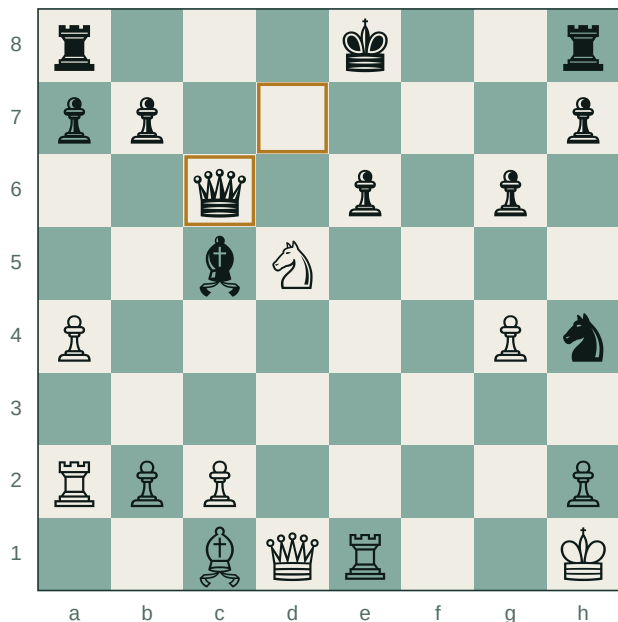


Attraction tactics: White, move 20

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 19...Qc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20. Rxe6+ Qxe6 21. Nc7+ Kf7 22. Nxe6

20.Rxe6+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. From e6 it attacks king on e8 and queen on c6. Recorded reply: **20...Qxe6**.

21.Nc7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From c7 it attacks king on e8, queen on e6 and rook on a8. Recorded reply: **21...Kf7**.

22.Nxe6 The knight captures the queen on e6.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on e8. Absolute pin: pawn on e6.